

RUH Airport Status

HALTED

As of 6:50 PM, Saturday 10 October 2026, Riyadh time (UTC+3)

292 flights cancelled today · last takeoff 1:39 PM · last landing 2:05 PM

Airport halted since 2:05 PM, 295 minutes with no takeoff or landing. Last takeoff XY277 at 1:39 PM; last landing SM461 at 2:05 PM. AP, Reuters, BBC and AFP report another attack/blast and evacuation; AFP cites dozens injured and five in ICU. Cancellations remain elevated.

HEADLINE

Airport halted since 2:05 PM (295 minutes, no takeoff or landing); 292 flights cancelled today so far.

There were 0 takeoffs in the last hour, the latest XY277 to Sharm el-Sheikh at 1:39 PM. The latest landing was SM461 from Cairo at 2:05 PM, with 0 landings in the last hour. 292 flights are cancelled today (148 departures, 144 arrivals) and 41 arrivals have diverted. **Yesterday, 9 October:** 166 of 703 flights cancelled, 18 arrivals diverted and four halts of 45+ minutes, the longest 7:41 to 9:38 PM (no landing until 9:45 PM). No official reason has been given for the evening stop. **This morning:** a 91-minute halt ran from 6:37 to 8:08 AM with no takeoff or landing. **This afternoon:** the board shows another stop since 2:05 PM — about 295 minutes with no takeoff or landing as of this check (last takeoff flynas XY277 at 1:39 PM; last landing Air Cairo SM461 at 2:05 PM). AP reports officials saying the airport was attacked again, evacuated and all air traffic stopped; Reuters reports a loud blast and travellers evacuated; BBC relays the same agencies and notes Saudi authorities have not commented; Flightradar24 says the last commercial landing was 2:05 PM local and flights bound for RUH are diverting, mainly to Jeddah. An AFP hospital source said dozens were injured and at least five Saudis were in intensive care; a separate AFP diplomatic source said Houthis hit the airport with a missile around 3:00 PM. No official Houthi claim for today found yet. King Khalid airport told passengers to confirm flight status before heading there. Air Arabia has suspended Sharjah–Riyadh through Sunday; SriLankan Airlines remains suspended to Riyadh until 18 October; Emirates, Etihad, flydubai and Air Arabia are still cutting UAE–Riyadh on Saturday. Board cancellations remain elevated.

292	1:39 PM	2:05 PM	0	41
FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY	LAST TAKEOFF	LAST LANDING	TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR	ARRIVALS DIVERTED
148 departures + 144 arrivals, 38% of 769 scheduled.	XY277 to Sharm el-Sheikh, 311 min before 6:50 PM.	SM461 from Cairo, 285 min before 6:50 PM.	0 landings in the last hour.	Mostly to Jeddah, Madinah, Dammam.

Cancellation basis: Flightradar24 RUH board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 6:50 PM. Flightradar24's own stats panel shows 278 (141 departures, 36%; 137 arrivals, 36%) at 6:51 PM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.

FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS

MEASURE	DEPARTURES	ARRIVALS	TOTAL	BASIS
Cancelled today	141 (36%)	137 (36%)	278	FR24 stats panel
Cancelled today, board count	148	144	292	FR24 boards, local day
Delayed today	130 (33%)	92 (24%)	222	FR24 stats panel
On time today (share of operated)	57 (30%)	41 (31%)	98	FR24 stats panel
Average delay, recent flights	0 min	0 min	—	FR24 stats panel
Disruption index (0–5)	2.74	2.12	—	FR24 stats panel
Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far	146 of 309	108 of 285	254 of 594	FR24 boards
Diverted today	—	41	41	FR24 arrivals board
Already cancelled tomorrow	48	71	119	FR24 stats panel
Cancelled yesterday (for scale)	75	96	171	FR24 stats panel

CANCELLATIONS BY AIRLINE, TOP 5	MOST-CANCELLED ROUTES, TOP 5
Saudia158	Jeddah69
flyadeal30	Dubai22
flynas15	Istanbul16
Riyadh Air10	Dammam15
Qatar Airways8	Madinah14

Source: Flightradar24 public airport data (airport.json details/stats panel, fetched 6:51 PM; departures and arrivals boards, fetched 6:50 PM). Rankings count both directions from the board for today. The stats panel and the board count slightly differently, so a few flights' difference is expected. Outbound diversions are not shown on the RUH board.

AIRPORT FLOW, LAST 24 HOURS

1Takeoffs and landings per hour, last 24 hours to 6:50 PM.

Recorded takeoffs (192) and landings (143) at RUH per hour over the last 24 hours, from 7:00 PM Friday to 6:50 PM, Riyadh time; the newest bar is the current, partial hour, * marks flights cancelled, at their scheduled time. Gray boxes are halts: 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing on the board, kept until they roll out of the window. Daily cancellation totals above are unchanged (local day, midnight to midnight). Source: Flightradar24 RUH departures and arrivals boards, fetched read-only. Halt times from the board (halts.json); dashed line = Flightradar24's X post.

Gray boxes mark halts of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing, worked out from the Flightradar24 board and kept until they roll out of the 24-hour window (clipped at the left edge): yesterday 1:58–3:14 PM, 4:05–4:50 PM, 7:41–9:38 PM, overnight 1:18–2:20 AM, this morning 6:37–8:08 AM, and the open afternoon halt since 2:05 PM.

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AIRSPACE NOW

Live traffic picture over Riyadh and the region.

RIYADH AREA

Flightradar24 live map, captured 6:52 PM AST. Centred on King Khalid International Airport, about 390 km across.

SAUDI ARABIA

Flightradar24 live map, captured 6:52 PM AST. Central and eastern Saudi Arabia, the Gulf, Bahrain, Qatar and the UAE coast.

Read with care: the maps show only aircraft that Flightradar24 tracks (ADS-B and similar feeds). Military, some state and transponder-off flights do not appear, and positions can lag by up to a minute. Yellow icons are aircraft; blue pins are airports.

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WATCHED GULF ROUTES

Next departures from RUH: 0 of 5 routes on schedule.

ROUTE	FLIGHT	AIRLINE	SCHEDULED	ESTIMATE	STATUS OF LISTED FLIGHT	CANCELLED
Dubai (DXB)	XY207	flynas	3:50 PM	3:50 PM	Has not left yet	11
Bahrain (BAH)	XY233	flynas	6:00 PM	6:00 PM	Has not left yet	1
Muscat (MCT)	OV206	SalamAir	Tmrw 3:00 PM	—	None until tomorrow 3:00 PM	4
Abu Dhabi (AUH)	EY556	Etihad Airways	4:45 PM	5:00 PM	Has not left yet	1
Doha (DOH)	QR8731	Qatar Airways	11:45 AM	—	Has not left yet	5

Source: Flightradar24 RUH departures board, fetched 6:50 PM. Cancelled = today's cancelled departures on the route. Status describes the listed flight itself: on schedule = no later estimate; delayed = estimate 15+ minutes after schedule. Dubai includes DXB only. Riyadh Air RX243 to Dubai, due 3:50 PM, finally left at 9:50 PM. Cancelled today include Emirates EK816, EK820, EK818, flydubai FZ848, FZ842, FZ856 and flynas XY217 to Dubai; Qatar Airways QR1167, QR1171, QR1241, QR1169, QR1165, QR1239 and QR1173 to Doha; Etihad EY552, EY556 and EY560 to Abu Dhabi; SalamAir OV206 to Muscat.

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NEWS AND STATEMENTS

Airport halted since 2:05 PM (~295 min); AP/Reuters/BBC/AFP: attack/blast/evac; AFP: dozens injured, 5 in ICU; diplomatic source says Houthi missile ~3:00 PM; FR24 stop + Jeddah diversions; GACA silent.

Checked at 6:54 PM: Reuters, AP, Arab News, SPA, GACA, Flightradar24 on X. Times are publication or post times, Riyadh time.

CONFIRMED BBC: RUH attacked again, evacuated after loud blast; Saudi authorities silent

BBC • 6:07 PM · published ~6:07 PM AST (BBC "45 minutes ago" at fetch); last checked 6:54 PM

BBC reports King Khalid International Airport was evacuated after a loud blast on Saturday, citing two international news agencies. It notes Reuters cited an eyewitness seeing more than a dozen ambulances, that Saudi authorities have not commented, and that the airport told passengers to check with their airline.

CONFIRMED AFP hospital source: dozens injured at RUH; at least 5 Saudis in intensive care

AFP • 6:20 PM · published ~6:20 PM AST (AFP via NAMPA/relays); last checked 6:54 PM

A hospital source in Riyadh told AFP that dozens of people were injured at the airport on Saturday, most of them Saudi nationals, and that at least five injured Saudis were in intensive care; some patients were transported by helicopter. Saudi authorities have not publicly confirmed casualty figures.

CONFIRMED AFP diplomatic source: Houthis hit RUH with a missile around 3:00 PM

AFP • 6:20 PM · published ~6:20 PM AST (AFP via NAMPA/relays); last checked 6:54 PM

A diplomatic source briefed on the matter told AFP that Yemen's Houthis attacked Riyadh airport with a missile at about 3:00 PM local time, calling the airport a civilian target. No official Houthi claim for Saturday was found as of this check; Saudi authorities have not publicly confirmed a strike cause.

CONFIRMED Flightradar24: strike reported; last landing 2:05 PM; diversions mainly to Jeddah

Flightradar24 • 5:51 PM · published 5:51 PM AST; last checked 6:54 PM

Flightradar24 says AP and Reuters among others are reporting a strike on Riyadh airport this afternoon. It notes the last commercial departure to land was at 2:05 PM local and the last departure at 1:39 PM, with flights bound for RUH diverting elsewhere, mainly to Jeddah.

CONFIRMED Reuters: loud blast at Riyadh airport; travellers evacuated; airlines cancel flights

Reuters • 5:35 PM · published 5:35 PM AST; last checked 6:54 PM

Reuters reports a loud blast at Riyadh airport as travellers were evacuated and airlines cancelled flights. Separate AFP and AP reporting describes evacuations and officials saying air traffic stopped. No Saudi official body has publicly confirmed an explosion or even a cause so far.

CONFIRMED AP: officials say RUH attacked again, evacuated, all air traffic stopped

AP • 5:10 PM · published ~5:10 PM AST (AP updated); last checked 6:54 PM

AP reports two regional officials saying King Khalid International Airport was attacked again on Saturday afternoon; one said it was evacuated and another said air traffic stopped. Iran-backed Houthis claimed earlier attacks this week; AP says there was no immediate Houthi statement Saturday. The airport issued an alert telling passengers to confirm flights before going there.

CONFIRMED AFP (via Sky News Arabia / MEE): witnesses describe evacuations; Saudi halted ~3:00 PM

AFP / Sky News Arabia / Middle East Eye • 5:04 PM · published ~5:01–5:04 PM AST; last checked 6:54 PM

AFP cites witnesses describing evacuations at the airport; one witness reported hearing a blast at about 3:00 PM. Middle East Eye relayed the AFP account; Reuters separately reported eyewitnesses hearing a loud explosion.

CONFIRMED King Khalid airport: confirm flight status before heading to the airport

AlArabiya / Riyadh Airports • 5:14 PM · published ~5:14 PM AST (5:14 PM GST); last checked 6:54 PM

Al Arabiya reports King Khalid International Airport issued an advisory telling travellers to contact their airline and confirm flight status before heading to the airport. The airport posted the same message on its official X account.

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METHOD AND LIMITS

What the numbers are, and are not.

• Board figures (last takeoff and landing, counts, cancellations, diversions, Gulf flights, chart) come from the Flightradar24 RUH boards (fetched at 6:50 PM, all pages for the local day. Flightradar24 is an unofficial aggregator, not a GACA or Riyadh Airports feed, and actual times can lag by a few minutes.

• The headline cancellation figure is the board count; Flightradar24's stats panel lags it by a few flights. Delayed, on-time, average-delay and index figures are the panel's own.

• Confidence tags: CONFIRMED = official statement made, or directly checked; CORROBORATED = multiple independent reports consistent with board data; UNVERIFIED = single or social reports not confirmed officially. Claims are attributed to their source.

PREPARED	BOARD DATA AS OF	SOURCES	STATUS	HANDLING	NEXT UPDATE
6:50 PM, Sat 10 Oct	6:50 PM	Flightradar24, Reuters, AP, AFP, Arab News, SPA, GACA, Dawn, Gulf News, Al Arabiya	Halted	Open sources · not official	8:00 PM